

FREE RESOURCE

Small Group Starter Kit

8 ready-to-run elementary group topics with ASCA alignment



Friendship Skills



Anger Management



Worry Warriors



Changing Families



Grief & Loss



Self-Esteem Builders



New Student Welcome



Social Skills

CLEAR PATH EDUCATION GROUP

FRIENDSHIP SKILLS

Grades K-2

Group 4-6

6-8 sessions

ASCA B-SS 1, 2

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Name game with compliments
- "What makes a good friend?" brainstorm
- Friendship recipe (ingredients of friendship)

KEY SKILLS

Sharing, turn-taking, using kind words, including others

ANGER MANAGEMENT

Grades K-5

Group 4-6

8 sessions

ASCA B-SS 2, 9

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Volcano drawing (when do you erupt?)
- Feelings thermometer check-in
- Anger iceberg (what's underneath?)

KEY SKILLS

Identifying triggers, deep breathing, walking away, using I-statements

WORRY WARRIORS (ANXIETY)

Grades 2-5

Group 4-6

6-8 sessions

ASCA B-SS 2, 7

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Worry jar (write worries, put them away)
- 5-4-3-2-1 grounding
- "Is this a BIG worry or a little worry?"

KEY SKILLS

Grounding techniques, positive self-talk, separating real vs. imagined fears

CHANGING FAMILIES (DIVORCE)

Grades K-5

Group 4-6

6 sessions

ASCA B-SS 2, 7, 8

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Two-homes drawing
- "Things that stay the same" list
- Feelings check-in with emojis

KEY SKILLS

Expressing feelings, understanding it's not their fault, coping with change

GRIEF & LOSS

Grades K-5

Group 3-5

6-8 sessions

ASCA B-SS 2, 7

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Memory box (bring something that reminds you)
- Feelings weather report
- Read "The Invisible String"

KEY SKILLS

Naming grief feelings, sharing memories, understanding grief is not linear

SELF-ESTEEM BUILDERS

Grades K-5

Group 5-6

6 sessions

ASCA B-SS 1, 4

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Superpower shield (draw your strengths)
- Compliment circle
- "I am..." poem

KEY SKILLS

Positive self-talk, identifying strengths, growth mindset

NEW STUDENT WELCOME

Grades K-5

Group 3-5

4 sessions

ASCA B-SS 1, 2, 6

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- School scavenger hunt
- "Two truths and a wish"
- Buddy system pairing

KEY SKILLS

Finding resources, making friends, asking for help

SOCIAL SKILLS

Grades K-3

Group 4-6

8 sessions

ASCA B-SS 2, 3, 4

OPENING ACTIVITIES

- Eye contact game
- Conversation starter cards
- Role-play phone call with a friend

KEY SKILLS

Listening, eye contact, reading body language, conversation skills

SESSION PLANNING TEMPLATE

Set up · Plan · Track progress

GROUP SETUP CHECKLIST

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Topic selected from card | ☐ Students identified (referral, teacher rec, self-referral) |
| ☐ Parent permission slips sent | ☐ Schedule set (same day/time each week) |
| ☐ Room reserved | ☐ Materials gathered |
| ☐ Teacher notification sent | ☐ Pre-assessment created |

SESSION PLANNING GRID

#	Date	Topic / Focus	Opening (5 min)	Main Activity (20 min)	Check-out (5 min)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					

PROGRESS TRACKING

Student	Pre (1-5)	Mid (1-5)	Post (1-5)	Growth

QUICK TIPS

- Keep groups to 30 minutes for K-2, 45 minutes for 3-5
- Same day, same time, same room = stability
- Confidentiality rule: what we say here stays here (except safety)
- End each session with a positive: one thing you're proud of today